# Elena Vasquez

she/her

Full-Stack Developer,
Cloud Architect

## Personal info


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## Links

- /elenavz
- /elena-vasquez
- /Elena_Vasquez

## Skills

- TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Go, Rust, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, GraphQL
- HTML, CSS, Sass, Tailwind
- Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, GCP
- Linux, macOS
- VS Code, IntelliJ, Neovim
- Git, CI/CD, Agile/Scrum

Grade scale: (1) very good ≈91%-100%, (2) good ≈81%-90%, (3) satisfactory ≈66%-80%, (4) sufficient ≈50%-65%, (5) failed ≈0%-49%

## Work Experience

### Zalando SE

**Full-time, Senior Full-Stack Engineer**

Jan 2021 – Present

- Led migration of monolithic checkout to microservices, reducing latency by 40%
- Designed real-time inventory sync processing 2M+ events/day using Kafka and Go
- Architected multi-region failover ensuring 99.99% uptime across EU data centers
- Mentored 4 junior developers through pair programming and code reviews

### N26 GmbH

**Full-time, Software Engineer**

Mar 2018 – Dec 2020

- Built customer onboarding flow serving 500K+ monthly signups across 25 markets
- Developed internal tooling for compliance team, cutting review time by 60%
- Implemented feature flag system enabling safe gradual rollouts to 7M+ users

### Freelance

**Contract, Web Developer**

Jun 2016 – Feb 2018

- Delivered 15+ client projects from e-commerce platforms to SaaS dashboards
- Built custom CMS for a Berlin media company processing 50K daily articles

## Education

### Computer Science, TU Berlin (M.Sc.)

Berlin  Oct 2014 – Sep 2016

Grade: 1.4  Specialization: Distributed Systems

Thesis: Event-driven architectures for real-time collaborative editing

### Computer Science, Univ. of Valencia (B.Sc.)

Valencia, Spain  Sep 2010 – Jun 2014

Grade: 8.7/10

Final Project: RESTful microservices framework in Node.js

## Projects

### Real-time Collaboration Engine

Zalando SE 2023

Built a CRDT-based collaborative editing system enabling multiple users to simultaneously edit product descriptions. Handles 10K concurrent sessions with sub-50ms sync latency.

Go, WebSocket, Redis, CRDTs

### Cloud Cost Optimizer

Zalando SE 2022

Developed an internal tool that analyzes AWS resource usage patterns and recommends right-sizing. Saved the team EUR 180K annually in cloud spend.

Python, AWS SDK, Grafana, Terraform

### Open-source Component Library

N26 2020 and ongoing

Created and maintained a React/TypeScript design system with 60+ components, used by 12 teams. Published on npm with 2K+ weekly downloads.

React, TypeScript, Storybook, Rollup

### E-commerce Platform Redesign

Freelance 2017

Led technical redesign of a fashion retailer's online store, improving page load from 4.2s to 1.1s and boosting conversion by 23%.

Next.js, PostgreSQL, Stripe, Vercel


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## Languages

- Spanish (Mother tongue)
- English (Fluent)
- German (C1)

## Certificates and Prizes

| | |
|---|---|
| 2023 | AWS Solutions Architect Professional |
| 2022 | Certified Kubernetes Administrator |
| 2021 | Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect |
| 2020 | HashiCorp Terraform Associate |
| 2019 | MongoDB Certified Developer |

## Hobbies

- Street photography
- Contributing to open-source projects

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## Speaking

- ReactDay Berlin 2023
- KubeCon EU 2022
- JSConf Berlin 2021

## Open Source

- crdt-collab (2.1K stars)
- cost-lens (890 stars)
- n26-react-ui contributor

Languages: TypeScript, Go, Python, Rust

## Technical Leadership

### Platform Architecture Initiative

Zalando SE 2023–Present

- Leading cross-team working group (12 engineers) defining platform standards for 250+ microservices
- Designed service mesh strategy using Istio, reducing inter-service latency by 30%
- Authored ADRs (Architecture Decision Records) adopted as standard across 6 engineering domains

### Engineering Excellence Program

Zalando SE 2022

- Established inner-source program enabling engineers to contribute to shared platform libraries
- Introduced weekly architecture guild (40+ members) raising the bar on system design
- Reduced new-engineer onboarding time from 3 weeks to 5 days via coding standards docs

## Publications

### Event-Driven Architectures in Practice

Zalando Engineering Blog 2023

Deep dive on migrating checkout to event-driven microservices. 45K+ reads.

### Real-Time Collaborative Editing with CRDTs

The Pragmatic Engineer 2023

Tutorial on operational transforms vs CRDTs for collaborative apps. 28K+ reads.

### Reducing Cloud Costs Without Reducing Velocity

InfoQ 2022

Case study on EUR 180K/year savings through automated resource governance. 19K+ reads.